

The Google Business Profile Checklist for Retail Shops

25 things to fix on your Google listing so locals walk past, glance at their phone, and step in.

Every day, people in your town pull out their phone and search "[thing they need] near me." Your Google Business Profile decides whether they walk into your shop, or someone else's three doors down.

This checklist fixes the bits most shop owners get wrong. Takes about an hour. Print it, tick each box as you go.

1. Foundation

THE BASICS — GET THESE WRONG AND NOTHING ELSE MATTERS

☐ Claim and verify your listing

If Google doesn't trust you own the shop, you can't edit anything. Search your business name on Google and look for "Own this business?"

☐ Business name matches the sign on the front of the shop

No keyword stuffing. "Megan's Gifts Best Homewares Bairnsdale" gets you suspended. Just your real shop name.

☐ Street address is correct and consistent

It must match exactly what's on your shopfront, your website, your invoices, and any directory listings. Google checks for consistency.

☐ Phone number is your shop line

The number you actually answer when it rings on the counter. Not a personal mobile that's silenced half the day.

☐ Website link points to your own site

Your own domain, your own product pages. Not your Facebook page, not your Etsy shop, not your Square ordering page.

2. Categories & Attributes

TELL GOOGLE EXACTLY WHAT YOU SELL

- ☐ **Primary category set as specifically as possible**
"Bookstore," "Hardware store," "Gift shop," "Bicycle shop," "Florist" — pick the most specific one. "Florist" beats "Retail store" every time.

- ☐ **Add 2–4 secondary categories**
"Stationery store," "Toy store," "Used bookstore," "Art supply store" if they apply. Don't pad with stuff you don't actually sell.

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- ☐ **Tick every relevant shopping attribute**
In-store shopping, in-store pickup, kerbside pickup, delivery, wheelchair-accessible entrance, free wi-fi, pet-friendly. Locals filter searches by these. Be honest about payment options too (cards-only, Afterpay, cash) so there's no awkward chat at the counter.

3. Hours & Contact

NO SURPRISES FOR PEOPLE WHO MADE THE TRIP IN

- ☐ **Trading hours accurate to the minute**
If you close at 4pm, set 4pm — not 5pm "just in case." Someone driving 20 minutes to find a locked door doesn't come back.
- ☐ **Public holidays and seasonal closures added**
Use the "Special hours" feature for Christmas Day, Boxing Day, Easter, Anzac Day, stocktake closures. "Open" on a public holiday when you're shut is a 1-star waiting to happen.

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- ☐ **Description fills the full 750 characters**
Plain English. Mention what you sell, your town, what makes your shop different (longest-running, locally-owned, specialist range), and whether you do gift wrapping / orders / repairs.

4. Products on GBP

SHOW UP FOR "[PRODUCT] NEAR ME" SEARCHES

- ☐ **Add your top sellers as products — photo + name + price**
In your GBP dashboard, add at least 10 products with clear photos, names, and current prices. Locals searching "[product] near me" see your listing pop up with that exact item.
- ☐ **Keep prices and stock current — remove out-of-stock lines**
A customer driving in for a specific item priced wrong (or sold out) is a guaranteed bad review. Update or remove items as stock changes.

5. Photos

THIS IS WHERE WALK-INS DECIDE WHETHER TO WALK IN

- ☐ **Storefront + signage from the street, daylight**
Wide shot showing the front door and signage clearly, so drivers and walk-ins recognise the place before they get to the door.
 - ☐ **Interior shots showing layout and displays**
Wide shots of the shop from the door, key displays, the counter. People want to know what they're walking into before they make the trip.
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- ☐ **Hero product + team-behind-counter shots, refreshed monthly**
Your best-sellers in daylight on a plain background (these show up in "[product] near me" searches), plus a real human face behind the counter so locals know who they're buying from. Add a fresh photo at least monthly; Google rewards active listings.

6. Foot Traffic & "In Stock" Signals

WHERE THE WALK-IN CUSTOMERS ACTUALLY COME FROM

- ☐ **"Pickup" and "in-store shopping" attributes turned on**
In your GBP dashboard, tick "In-store shopping," "In-store pickup," "Kerbside pickup" if you offer them. These trigger "available nearby" labels in Google searches.
 - ☐ **Phone calls enabled — people will ring before driving in**
Make sure the call button is set. Half of "near me" searchers will ring to check stock before making the trip. A missed call is a missed sale.
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- ☐ **Messaging turned on (and someone's watching it)**
Lets locals text you from search to ask "do you have X in stock?" Big trust signal. Be ready to reply within an hour during trading.

Why this matters

"Near me" searches are how local shops actually win against the big online retailers. Someone who needs the item TODAY can't wait for an Amazon delivery — if your listing tells them you're 3km away, open, and have it in stock, they're walking in. Every "near me" search you don't show up for goes to a competitor.

7. Reviews, Posts & Q&A

THE ONGOING WORK THAT KEEPS YOU AHEAD OF QUIETER COMPETITORS

☐ **Reply to every review — good and bad**

Within 48 hours. By name, personalised, never copy-paste. A polite, professional reply to a 2-star wins more new customers than the bad review costs.

☐ **Set up a review request system**

A small card at the counter with your Google review QR code, a follow-up text after a big purchase, a sticker on the bag. Aim for one new review per week.

☐ **Get your short Google review link**

In your GBP dashboard, click "Ask for reviews" — copy that short link, save it, print it on the counter card.

☐ **Post an update every 2–4 weeks**

New stock arrivals, a sale, a seasonal range, a new product line. Counts as a fresh signal to Google and shows up directly in your listing.

☐ **Pre-load the Q&A section**

Add the questions locals actually ask — parking, gift wrapping, layby, returns, do-you-stock-X — and answer them yourself. Saves you replying 50 times.

Done it all? Here's what's next.

If you've ticked every box, your Google Business Profile is now in better shape than 95% of independent shops in your town. Want a hand keeping walk-in traffic coming through your door instead of past it? Get in touch — find me on Facebook or Instagram as Your Mate Agency, or my email and number are right below.

Your Mate Agency — helping regional businesses get found online.

Built by Matt Rowlands in Mallacoota, East Gippsland.

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